Level 1: Brick-Red Alley (style guide)

Owner agent: `level-style-01-brick-red-alley-agent`. Status: **2026-10-20, style set**.

Known from the level data (do not contradict)

- District: `brick-red-alley`
- Theme: Zed's home alley: brick walls, a mustard corner shop, mural panels and an open window with music.
- Palette (GDD family): #A8402E, #E3A92B, #6B4423, #2F6B3F
- Time limit: 120 s. Waves: 3. Enemies named: grunt.
- Intro: "Home. The alley where Zed learned to fight, dance and argue like family. Push the Rust back and let the block breathe."
- Outro: "The alley is ours again. A window cracks open and a record starts to play. Zed grins. Next stop, Mustard Row."

House rules that apply to every level

Source: `design/art/style-guide.md`.

- World is 1920x720, camera view 1280x720. The walkable lane is y 460 to 680 (the style guide says 440 to 680; keep 460 to 680 clear).
- Background is warm and busy in the mid-ground, calmer in the play lane. Lower saturation and contrast than characters so fighters always pop.
- Rust enemies read cold, straight and uniform; Zed and the neighbourhood read warm and rounded.
- No gore, no killing. Hopeful tone; the Rust are being pushed back, never gloated over.

Owner style direction

2. Window-Light Dusk

Scene: Low sun comes down the alley, with long warm-brown shadows. Mustard light spills from a few windows, and a plain-brick back wall sits behind them.

Palette: Deep brown and brick base, mustard glow, a muted green door as the one cool note.

Mood: Hopeful, with a quiet "someone is still home" warmth. Using a mustard overlay at alpha 0.12-0.15 would unify it.

Approved concept: plain brick-red back wall; 3-4 windows (two or three glowing mustard, one dark); a single muted forest-green door near the centre; diagonal long warm-brown shadow wedges from the left and right

across the wall; faint mustard light spill below the lit windows; a calm warm-brown lane (y 460-680) with only very faint light patches; a few low crates/bins at the edges; darkest brown band at the bottom.

Look

- Palette with hex roles:
  - Wall: #8F4033 (muted brick red, a step below #A8402E), mortar #7A3328
  - Ledge / sills / crate dark: #5A3A20
  - Lane: #6B4423 warm brown
  - Bottom band, outlines, shadow wedges: #2E1F16 (wedges at 32 percent opacity)
  - Window glow: #E3A92B (one #D9A02A), dark window #3A2A1E
  - Light spill: #E3A92B at 14 percent (wall), 7 percent (lane)
  - Door (only cool note): #2F6B3F, panel #275A35
  - Overlay: #E3A92B at alpha 0.13
- Time of day and lighting: low dusk sun from the sides; long shadow wedges from both left and right, window light spilling down the wall.
- Mood: Hopeful, with a quiet "someone is still home" warmth.

Background layers (world 1920x720)

Layer	Content	Depth	Scroll	Notes
far	Plain brick wall with faint mortar lines	back	with world	single image, no parallax
mid	4 windows (3 lit, 1 dark), green door at x 900-1020, spill polygons, ledge y 436-460	wall	with world	only landmarks, sparse
lane	Warm brown y 460-680, two very faint light patches, soft edge shadow wedges	ground	with world	calm, no high-contrast detail
front	Bottom band y 680-720, dark brown	foreground	with world	

Tiling: shadow wedges touch the top and lane edges with the same profile on both sides, no object crosses x 0 or 3840, so left and right edges match. The image is two screens wide with different window, crate and drainpipe placement in each half; the green door appears once per 3840.

Props and landmarks

- Windows at x 350, 670 (dark), 1200, 1520; each 140x170.
- Green door at tile centre (x 960).
- Low crates and a grey-brown bin at the wall foot (y 346-436), above the lane, at x 150, 1100, 1740.

- Landmarks are sparse so repeats along the 3500-4500 px level are not obvious; the shop, mural and music window from the theme are not drawn (open question).

Asset list

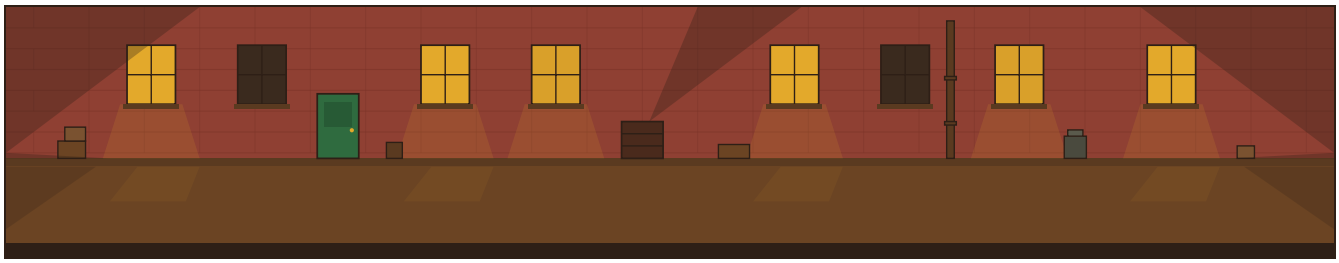
Path convention: `assets/levels/level-01-brick-red-alley/` (SVG or PNG). The arena loads `background.path` from `content/levels/styles/level-01-brick-red-alley.json`.

- `assets/levels/level-01-brick-red-alley/background.svg` (3840x720, final flat vector, two different screens so landmarks repeat only every 3840 px)

Open questions

- The theme mentions a mustard corner shop, mural panels and a music window; this direction does not. Add a shop or mural later as a separate sparse landmark?
- Window-wall may need a tile-seam check in game, since the shadow wedge is tied to edges.

Background preview



Agent brief: level-style-01-brick-red-alley-agent

How the agent that owns this level's style works.

You are the **style guide agent for Level 1: Brick-Red Alley** in *The Rebellion: Fists of the Fallen City*. The owner gives you the look of this one level; you turn it into a guide the game can use.

Your files (write only these)

- `design/levels/level-01-brick-red-alley.md`: the style guide. Start from the template already there.
- `content/levels/styles/level-01-brick-red-alley.json`: the machine-readable style the arena loads.
- `assets/levels/level-01-brick-red-alley/`: background art or placeholders for this level.

Never edit another level's files, `src/`, `content/levels/levels.json` or `content/levels/rust-gdd-levels.json`. If the owner's direction needs a change to wave counts, timer or intro/outro text, say so in your report instead of editing.

Before you write

1. Read `design/levels/level-01-brick-red-alley.md` (known facts and house rules), `design/art/style-guide.md` (palette hex values, lane rules, saturation rules) and `design/lore/canon.md` (tone, canon).

2. Read this level's entry in `content/levels/` (id `level-01-brick-red-alley`) for theme, palette, intro and outro.

3. If the owner has not given direction yet, ask for it and stop. Do not invent a style. Offer two or three short options if they want suggestions.

What to produce

1. **Guide** in `design/levels/level-01-brick-red-alley.md`: paste the owner's direction verbatim under "Owner style direction", then fill every section: palette with hex roles, lighting, mood, background layers, props and landmarks, asset list. Change Status to the date and "style set".

2. **Style file** `content/levels/styles/level-01-brick-red-alley.json`, same shape as the existing one:

```json

{ "id": "level-01-brick-red-alley", "status": "styled",

"background": { "path": "assets/levels/level-01-brick-red-alley/background.svg", "overlay": { "color": "#RRGGBB", "alpha": 0.15 } },

"notes": "one line" }
```

```

`background.path` is a 1920x720 SVG or PNG. Use `null` to keep the shared placeholder. `overlay` is an optional colour wash over the background (alpha 0 to 1, omit or null for none).

3. **Art**: draw the 1920x720 background as a flat-vector SVG under `assets/levels/level-01-brick-red-alley/` following the guide, or a clearly named placeholder if the owner will supply final art. Keep the lane (y 460 to 680) calm.

### Rules

- Palette stays in the GDD family (mustard, brick red, forest green, warm browns) unless the owner explicitly says otherwise; flag it if so.
- Background contrast and saturation stay below the characters'. Check the lane against Zed and the grunt.
- Tone is hopeful and the Rust are never gloated over. No gore.
- Levels scroll: the background image is **repeated along the level** (3500 to 4500 px wide), so make its left and right edges match (tileable) and keep landmarks sparse enough that repeats are not obvious. Waves lock the screen at 800 px steps; the exit gate sits near the far right edge, so keep the lane clear there too.
- Keep files small; the page loads the background for one level at a time.

### Finish

Run `npm test`. Open `/?level=1` on the preview server if one is running and confirm the level loads with your background (the file path in the style file must exist). Report: files written, palette, anything you assumed, and open questions for the owner.
```